

Build Your HTML Template Library

Year 11 Web Development • Multi-lesson task

THE BIG IDEA

Real web developers do not write every site from scratch. They keep a folder of template pages they have built before, and copy the parts they need into new projects.

Over the next few lessons you are going to build your own template library. By the end you will have THREE complete template pages — each with a different style of header, navigation, and footer — that you can reuse later when you start designing real websites.

Key Terminology

Term	Plain-English Meaning
Template	A starting page you can copy and reuse. The structure is already built — you just change the content.
Header	The top section of a webpage. Usually contains a logo and the navigation.
Navigation (nav)	The links that let users move between pages of a website.
Footer	The bottom section of every webpage. Usually has copyright info, links, or contact details.
Hero image	A large eye-catching image (or banner) at the top of the main content area. Often has text or a button on top.
Container	A div that wraps content to keep it organised. We use a page-container to set a max width and centre everything.

The Starter Structure

Every template you build will use this same basic skeleton. We will code this together at the start of the lesson:

```
<div class="page-container">

  <header >
    <!-- logo and title and sometimes nav also goes in here-->
  </header>
  <nav >
    <!-- menu links go here -->
  </nav>

  <div class="main-container">
    <!-- main page content goes here -->
  </div>

  <footer
    <!-- copyright and footer links go here -->
```

</footer>

</div>

The Task

Three templates, three styles

You need to build three separate template pages. Each one must have:

- a different style of **header and navigation** from the others
- a different style of **footer** from the others
- an empty `<div class="main-container">` in the middle (we will fill these later)
- its own external stylesheet (**style.css**)
- ONE of your three templates must include a **hero image** inside the main-container

How to organise your files

Set up a folder called **templates** with three subfolders inside, one for each template:

```
templates/  
  template-1/  
    index.html  
    style.css  
    images/  
  template-2/  
    index.html  
    style.css  
    images/  
  template-3/  
    index.html  
    style.css  
    images/
```

SUGGESTED ORDER OF WORK

1. Set up your folder structure (above) before you start coding.
2. Pick three different header styles and three different footer styles from the next page (or invent your own).
3. Sketch each template on paper **FIRST** so you know what you are building.
4. Build template 1 fully (header, footer, then the hero image if this is your hero one) before moving on.
5. Repeat for template 2 and template 3.

Header & Navigation Style Ideas

Pick three different ones for your three templates

Style Name	What it looks like	Try this if you want to learn...
Classic horizontal	Logo on the left, nav links lined up on the right. The most common style on real websites.	<i>Flexbox with justify-content: space-between.</i>
Centred logo	Logo in the middle (top), nav links sitting underneath in a horizontal row.	<i>Stacking layouts and centring with text-align.</i>
Stacked bar	Logo and tagline on top, then a full-width coloured nav bar across underneath.	<i>Dividing a header into two visual rows.</i>
Split nav	Half the nav links on the left of the logo, half on the right. Logo sits in the middle.	<i>Three-column flexbox layouts.</i>
Sidebar nav	Navigation runs vertically down the left-hand side instead of along the top.	<i>flex-direction column and full-height layouts.</i>
Dark vs light	A header with a dark background and white text vs a light header with dark text.	<i>Colour contrast and accessibility.</i>

Footer Style Ideas

Pick three different footer styles to match your three templates.

Style Name	What it looks like	Try this if you want to learn...
Simple line	One short line of text, centred. Just a copyright notice — that is it.	<i>Basic alignment, padding, and minimal design.</i>
Multi-column	Three or four columns side by side: About, Quick Links, Contact, Social.	<i>Flexbox with multiple sections side-by-side.</i>
Two-row	Top row has links and contact info, bottom row has a thin copyright line.	<i>Stacking sections inside a footer.</i>
Big footer	A large coloured footer with a heading, links, and a fake newsletter signup form.	<i>Combining headings, links, and form inputs.</i>
Minimal dark bar	Tiny footer — just a thin dark strip with a single line of small text.	<i>Working with thin sections and small text.</i>
Logo + links	Logo on the left, a row of small links on the right (like a mini header).	<i>Mirroring the header design at the bottom.</i>

Hero Image Ideas

ONE of your three templates needs a hero image

A **hero image** is the big banner image you see at the top of most modern websites. It usually sits inside the **main-container** right under the header. Choose ONE of these styles for the template that has a hero:

Style Name	What it looks like	Try this if you want to learn...
Full-width banner	An image stretched across the full width with no text on it. Just a big visual statement.	<i>width: 100% and image sizing.</i>
Image + heading overlay	Background image with a big heading and a subtitle laid on top of it.	<i>Positioning text on top of an image.</i>
Image + button overlay	Image with a heading AND a 'Click here' / 'Learn More' button on top.	<i>Buttons, hover states, calls to action.</i>
Side-by-side	Image on one side (left or right), heading and paragraph text on the other side.	<i>Two-column flexbox layouts.</i>
Half-screen hero	Image takes up half the screen height (50vh), text underneath.	<i>Using vh units to size sections.</i>

WHERE TO FIND FREE IMAGES

Use **free, royalty-free images** from one of these sites — never just grab images off Google!

- **unsplash.com** — high-quality photos, free to use
- **pexels.com** — similar to Unsplash, also free
- **pixabay.com** — photos, illustrations, and vector graphics

Save your images into the **images/** folder of whichever template uses them, then link to them with a relative path:

```

```

Paste screens shots of your 3 made pages:

Page 1:

Page 2:

Page 3:

Finished Already?

Extension challenges — pick one (or more!) and research it

HOW THIS WORKS

Once you have all three of your main templates done, do not just sit and wait. Pick one of the challenges below and start a NEW template (template-4, template-5, etc.) where you research and try out a more advanced technique.

You will need to **research** how each of these works. Try **W3Schools**, **MDN Web Docs**, **CSS-Tricks**, or YouTube tutorials. The goal is not just to copy code — try to understand what each line does and write a short comment explaining it.

Header & Nav challenges

Style Name	What it looks like	Try this if you want to learn...
Sticky header	A header that 'sticks' to the top of the screen when you scroll down so the nav is always visible.	<i>position: sticky and z-index.</i>
Hamburger menu	Three horizontal lines that open up a menu when clicked (used on mobile sites).	<i>Using checkboxes or tiny bits of JS to toggle a menu.</i>
Drop-down menu	Hover over a nav link and a sub-menu drops down with more options.	<i>Nested ul/li and CSS hover states.</i>
Animated underline	Hover over a nav link and a smooth animated underline slides in.	<i>CSS transitions and the ::after pseudo-element.</i>
Two-row utility header	A thin top bar with phone/email/login, with the main nav underneath.	<i>Stacking different types of content in a single header.</i>

Hero & main area challenges

Style Name	What it looks like	Try this if you want to learn...
Dark overlay hero	A hero image with a semi-transparent dark layer on top so the white text is easier to read.	<i>rgba() colours, opacity, and stacking with z-index.</i>
Hero with CTA button	A hero with a heading, a paragraph, AND a styled call-to-action button that changes on hover.	<i>Button design, hover states, and transitions.</i>
Gradient overlay hero	A hero with a colourful gradient layer on top of the image instead of a flat colour.	<i>linear-gradient() and combining gradients with images.</i>
Video background hero	A short looping background video instead of a static image.	<i>The HTML <video> tag with autoplay, loop, and muted.</i>

Footer challenges

Style Name	What it looks like	Try this if you want to learn...
Newsletter signup	Footer with a working-looking email input box and 'Subscribe' button.	<i>Form inputs and styling input + button as one unit.</i>
Social icon row	Row of social media icons (use Font Awesome or simple coloured circles).	<i>Linking icon libraries and styling links as buttons.</i>
Embedded map	Footer with a Google Map iframe showing a fake business location.	<i><iframe> elements and embedding external content.</i>
Sticky footer	A footer that always sits at the bottom of the screen even on a short page.	<i>min-height: 100vh and flexbox layouts.</i>

DOCUMENT WHAT YOU LEARN

For each extension challenge you try, write a short comment at the top of your HTML file (or in a separate notes.txt) covering:

- What is the technique called?
- Where did you find your information? (URL)
- What is the most important property/element that makes it work?
- Could you use this on a real website you build later? Why or why not?